

FAQs

More the RAM, better the performance

Q. I am in the process of finalising the configuration of my new PC, and want to know whether 512 MB of RAM is sufficient to run Maya, or should I opt for 1 GB of RAM?

Kumaresh

A Minimum memory requirements depend on the applications you use. For office applications 256 MB is enough; for 2D image editing tools 512 MB should be sufficient, while for AV and 3D, a minimum of 1 GB is necessary. Basically, as much RAM as you can afford and cram into your system is recommended. Maya will definitely run with 512 MB of RAM, but will be sluggish.

Free e-mail via POP3

I wanted to know if there are any free POP3 e-mail Web sites. I am sick of using Hotmail and the like, as they are too slow.

Nikhil

A Most free e-mail service providers do not provide POP3 mail access. Some providers such as *Spymac.com*, *Myrealbox.com*, etc, offer POP3 access. Of course, they charge a premium for this, for example, *Rediffmail.com*. You can also try Yahoo! Pops (<http://yahoopops.sourceforge.net>), which lets you download e-mail via POP3 from the popular and free e-mail provider, Yahoo!. Download the free tool and install it on your machine. Now configure your POP3/SMTP server address in your e-mail client to 127.0.0.1. Also you need to change the timeout in the advanced settings to three minutes or more, otherwise the e-mail client will keep getting disconnected and no mails will download.

One OS in dual boot failed

Q. I have both Windows 98 and Windows XP installed on my system. For some time now I've been having problems with Windows Explorer whenever I start Windows 98, I get an error that says,

"Explorer has performed an illegal operation and will be shut down". If I format and re-install Windows 98 SE, will my Windows XP install be affected?

Soumya Seal

A It all depends on how the OSes are installed. If both Windows 98 and Windows XP exist on the same partition, you'll have to delete the Windows 98 'Windows' folder. Next, you'll have to modify the boot.ini file, and remove the line corresponding to Windows 98.

Your safest bet is to reinstall Windows 98 with the Upgrade option. After this you need to boot via the XP bootable CD, select the Recovery Console option, login via administrator privileges and execute the fixboot.exe and fixmbr.exe commands. However, If both OSes reside on different partitions, all you need to do is format the partition that contains Windows 98, reinstall it to the same partition and modify the boot.ini file as mentioned earlier.

then either get a patch if available or get a newer version of the software.

Protection error

Q. I have a Motorola SM56 PCI speakerphone modem. Whenever I connect to the Internet, the connection gets disconnected and the system display reads, "Windows protection error. Press any key to continue" and then it shuts down. The only advice I've received is to format my hard disk. Also, can you let me know where I can find the drivers for Windows XP for the modem?

Karthik

A The drivers for the Motorola SM56 PCI card are available at http://www.motorola.com/softmodem/sm56_download.htm. Depending upon the modem, for example, if the modem is Data/Fax/Voice, Data/Fax, etc, choose the file to download. Actually, the Web page offers drivers for all operating systems and for both ISA and PCI modems. Choose the proper file.

Designers' choice

Q. One of our clients wants to purchase an AMD Athlon 64-based system. He is a

graphic designer, and uses Photoshop most often, working with files of sizes in excess of 500 MB. What system would be ideal here?

I downloaded Microsoft XP, the 64-bit edition. Does it give good performance with the Athlon 64? Also, how should I configure the system for best performance?

Krishna Prasad

A You should opt for an Athlon 64. It gives better performance than the Intel Prescott. Also, in memory-intensive applications like Photoshop, an Athlon 64 will give much better performance, as the memory controller is within the CPU, as against the Prescott, where the memory controller resides on the Northbridge.

The second factor is memory. The RAM needs to be high enough, say 768 i.e. 512 + 256 MB.

Fibre optic vs WiFi LAN

Q. I have a five-PC network on a CAT 5 cable and a hub. What do I need to set up a fibre optic cable network. I'd also like to know what's needed to set up a WiFi network, and the approximate costs involved.

Anil Gupta

A Setting up a fibre-optic LAN would be

a very costly affair, and also a tedious and complicated process. You'll need a LAN card with optical fibre cable connectors, an optical fibre switch, an optical fibre patch cable and connectors. You will also need equipment to connect the cables to the connector, etc, basically, lots of costly equipment. Fibre-optic connectivity is used to set up a high-speed backbone, while WiFi is used for connecting people on the fly. WiFi is simpler and also comparatively less expensive, but definitely more expensive than a wired LAN. You will need a WiFi access point, which would cost around Rs 10,000, and five WiFi cards costing around Rs 3,000 each. The software needed to set up the access point comes bundled with the hardware. **d**



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!